DA test plan

Thank you for testing DA. This plan walks through everything DA does, step by step: first with the **menu** (what most people use), then with **commands typed in a terminal** (for things the menu doesn't have). Each step says what to do and what you should see. Tick the box when it works; when it doesn't, write down the step's number (like **D7**) and what happened, and see Reporting a problem.

You don't need to do it all in one sitting: each part starts from where the one before left off. The whole plan takes a few evenings. The user guide explains anything this plan mentions; the known problems list what's already known, so you don't need to report those.

Before you start

- **Use copies, never your only photos.** DA never deletes anything and asks before it moves anything, but this is a test: copy some photos into a new folder and test with those.
- **A Windows PC** with about 5 GB free, and an internet connection for a few steps (places, updates).
- **Write down your DA version** (it's shown in step A5) when you report anything.
- Words used here: an **archive** is the folder DA looks after; **intake** is where you put new files; a **sidecar** is the small `.meta.json` file DA keeps beside each photo; the **menu** is what opens when you double-click an archive's `Open DA.cmd` (or type `da`).

Make a test kit

Make a folder `C:\DA-test-kit` and put copies of these in it. The more kinds you have, the more of the plan you can try; skip a step whose files you don't have and mark it **skipped**.

Folder in the kit	What to put in it	Used in
`phone`	20-50 photos from a phone (JPG or HEIC), some taken outdoors (they have a location)	C, H, K, L
`phone`	2-3 iPhone **Live Photos** (each is a `.HEIC` or `.JPG` plus a `.MOV` with the same name)	I
`phone`	2-3 ordinary videos (`.mov` or `.mp4` , longer than 5 seconds)	I
`camera`	5-10 photos from a different camera (another phone, or a digital camera)	H, K
`scans`	5 scans of old prints (JPG/PNG/TIFF that have **no date** in them or in their name)	G, J
`docs`	3-5 PDFs (bills, letters) and a Word or Excel file	G
`doubles`	3 photos that are **exact copies** of photos in `phone` (copy them again)	F
`old`	3-5 photos taken in a different decade from the rest (say 2005 if the rest are 2020s)	M
`other`	an old camera video (`.AVI` / `.MPG`), a `.CR2` / `.NEF` raw file with its JPG, a screenshot	D, I

A. Install DA

#	Do this	You should see	OK
A1	Open https://da.gamenightbymike.com	The DA User Guide, with a **Download DA** button and a contents list on the left	☐
A2	Click **Download DA**	`DA.exe` downloads (about 75 MB); if the browser asks, choose **Keep**	☐
A3	In File Explorer, go to Downloads, click the address bar, type `powershell`, press Enter	A blue/black terminal window opens in Downloads	☐
A4	Type `.\DA.exe install` and press Enter	"Installed C:\Scripts\DA\DA.exe and added it to your PATH" (or "already on your PATH")	☐
A4a	If instead you see "*an application control policy has blocked this file*" or a Windows Security warning that won't go away	Go to step **A10** (install with Python) and skip A5-A9	☐
A4b	If you see "*Windows protected your PC*"	Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**; then A4 works	☐
A5	Close the terminal, open a **new** one (Windows key, type `powershell`, Enter), type `da version`	`DA v2026.10.…` - write this version down	☐
A6	Type `da --help`	A list of commands (setup, run, status, archives, guide, …)	☐
A7	Type `da guide`	The user guide opens in your browser	☐
A8	Type `da guide --pdf`	The guide's PDF opens	☐
A9	Type `da update`	It says which version you have and how to get the newest DA.exe	☐
A10	*(Python install - only if Windows blocks DA.exe, or to test it)* Follow the guide's Install DA with Python: install Python from python.org	`py --version` in a new terminal shows `Python 3.…`	☐
A11	Type the guide's first line: `py -m venv C:\Scripts\DA\python`	No error; the folder `C:\Scripts\DA\python` exists	☐
A12	Type the second line (`…python.exe -m pip install -r https://da.gamenightbymike.com/python/requirements.txt`)	It downloads and ends with "Successfully installed … devmukmuk-da-…"	☐
A13	Type the third line (`…python.exe -m mindit install`)	"Installed C:\Scripts\DA\da.cmd (DA run by Python …)"; if a DA.exe was there: "Set aside DA.exe (now DA.exe.off)"	☐
A14	New terminal: `da version`	The version, with **no** Windows Security pop-up	☐
A15	`da update`	"Downloading the newest DA …" then "Now: DA v…"	☐

#	Do this	You should see	OK
A16	Outside any archive, type `da status`	"Not inside an archive" and how to open one (no crash)	☐
A17	Type `da` on its own (outside any archive)	"You're not inside an archive" and an offer to create one (answer **n** for now)	☐

B. Create an archive

#	Do this	You should see	OK
B1	In a terminal: `da setup C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x --years 2020-2029`	"Archive ready" and the folder's path	☐
B2	Open `C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x` in File Explorer	`da-archive.yaml`, `Open DA.cmd`, and folders `intake` (with `photos`, `docs`, `scans`), `photos`, `documents`, `output`, `logs`	☐
B3	Open `da-archive.yaml` in Notepad (right-click, Open with, Notepad), then close it	`name: "jane-archive-202x"`, `years: "2020-2029"`, the intake folders, `contact_sheets: layout: 3x4`	☐
B4	Double-click `Open DA.cmd`	A window opens: a box with the archive's name, folder and years, then the **Status** (intake: 0 files), then the menu keys	☐
B5	Look at the menu	Keys **1-7**, **L**, **S**, **M**, **R**, **D**, **J**, **U**, **H**, **Q**	☐
B6	Press **H**, Enter	A short "How DA works" help, and a list of commands	☐
B7	Press **U**, Enter	The user guide opens in the browser	☐
B8	Press **x** (not a menu key), Enter	"Pick one of the numbers or letters shown." and the menu again	☐
B9	Press **Q**, Enter	The menu closes; the window stays open with a line saying you can type `da` for the menu	☐
B10	Type `da` in that window	The menu again, starting with the Status	☐
B11	Press **7** (New archive), Enter	"Archives on this PC already:" with `jane-archive-202x … <- open now`, then a question for a new folder	☐
B12	Type `C:\DA-test\sam-archive-200x`, Enter; years `2000-2009`, Enter	"Archive ready", and the menu now shows **sam-archive-200x** with its Status	☐
B13	Press **6** (Switch archive), Enter	Both archives listed with their years; type the number of **jane-archive-202x**	☐
B14		The menu shows jane-archive-202x again, with its Status	☐
B15	Press Q. In the same window type `da archives`	A table of this PC's archives (name, years, folder)	☐
B16	`da archives --open 2`	The second archive's menu opens (press Q to leave)	☐

#	Do this	You should see	OK
B17	`da setup C:\DA-test\sam-archive-200x --years 2000-2009` again	It says the archive is already there and keeps its settings (nothing moved)	☐
B18	Make a folder `C:\DA-test\filled`, copy 3 kit photos into it, then `da setup C:\DA-test\filled`	It lists what's in the folder and asks before moving those into `intake\`; answer **n**	☐
B19	Run it again and answer **y**	The 3 photos are now in `C:\DA-test\filled\intake\`, and the archive's files appear	☐
B20	`da setup C:\DA-test\bad --years 1999-1990`	A clear message that years must look like 1990-1999 (nothing made)	☐

C. The first run: process intake (menu 1)

Copy the whole test kit (except `old`) into `jane-archive-202x\intake\photos\kit` (so `kit\phone`, `kit\camera`, … are inside), copy `scans` into `intake\scans`, and `docs` into `intake\docs`.

#	Do this	You should see	OK
C1	Open jane-archive-202x (its `Open DA.cmd`)	The Status shows the intake files, folder by folder, with counts	☐
C2	Press **1** (Process intake)	"Counting what's in intake ...", then a list of intake's folders with file counts	☐
C3	Type the number of `photos` to open it	Its subfolders (`kit`) are listed; you can open further, go up, or filter by name	☐
C4	Type part of a name (for example `kit`) to filter	Only matching folders are listed	☐
C5	Go back up to the top of intake and choose to process **all of intake**	"Processing ... DA asks before moving anything"	☐
C6	Watch step **1/7 Indexing**	A count of files indexed, no error	☐
C7	Step **2/7 Hashing**	A progress count, then a summary	☐
C8	Step **3/7** (duplicates): it asks whether to set exact copies aside; answer **y**	The 3 `doubles` are listed and moved to `_duplicates-holding` (see F)	☐
C9	Step **4/7 Preview**	"planning names and folders (nothing moves)" and a plan: how many files to file, how many need review	☐
C10	Step **5/7 Plan/check**	Numbers of files to file, raw files and Live Photo videos going with them, and problems to review	☐
C11	It asks whether to file them; answer **n**	It stops; nothing was moved; the run is recorded in `output\runs\`	☐
C12	Press **1** again and process all of intake again; answer **y** to each question	Steps 1-7 run; "Filed N; hash ok N; problems: 0" and "Done. Run record: ..."	☐
C13		Right after, "Where things stand now:" and the Status (fewer files waiting)	☐
C14	In File Explorer open `photos\organized`	Year folders (`2021`, ...) with month folders (`2021-06`, ...)	☐
C15	Open a month folder	Files named `photo_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS_xxxx.jpg` (or `.heic`) in date order, each with a `.meta.json` beside it, and a `_contact-sheet.pdf`	☐
C16	Check one photo's name against when it was taken (its date in the Photos app)	The date and time in the name match	☐
C17	Open one `.meta.json` in Notepad	A text file with `"schema": {"name": "mindit.sidecar", "version": 2}`, a `file` block with its sha256, and a `camera` block	☐

#	Do this	You should see	OK
C18	Look in `intake\photos\kit`	Only files that need you are left (no date, other decade, ...)	☐
C19	Back in the menu, press **2** (Status)	Organized photos/documents counts and the last run's time and "filed N"	☐
C20	Process intake a third time	"Nothing to file" (or only the review ones are planned) - nothing is filed twice	☐

D. What needs review (menu 3)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
D1	Press **3**	Groups of what the last run left, each with a reason and up to 5 examples	☐
D2		**No date (in the file or its name)**: your scans of prints and any undated files	☐
D3		If you included a photo from another decade in `kit` : **Taken outside this archive's years**	☐
D4		"Full list: ...\review.csv"	☐
D5	Open that `review.csv` (double-click; it opens in Excel or Notepad)	One row per file: reason, file, detail	☐
D6	The screenshot from `other`	Filed by a date in its name, or listed under No date - not a crash	☐
D7	The raw file (`.CR2` / `.NEF`)	Moved and renamed together with its JPG (same new name, raw extension), not left alone	☐
D8	A raw file whose JPG isn't there	Left in intake	☐

E. Status and the index (menu 2, 5)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
E1	Press **2**	The same numbers as the box at the top, plus intake folder by folder	☐
E2	In File Explorer, move one filed photo (and its `.meta.json`) to your Desktop		☐
E3	Press **5** (Refresh index)	It indexes, then the counts drop by one	☐
E4	Move the photo back where it was, press **5**	Counts back up	☐
E5	Terminal (in the archive): `da db stats`	Counts by year and kind	☐
E6	`da db query "SELECT file_name, captured_at FROM files WHERE area = 'photos' LIMIT 5"`	Five photos with their dates	☐
E7	`da db query "DELETE FROM files"`	Refused: only SELECT is allowed (nothing deleted)	☐
E8	`da status`	The same Status as menu 2	☐
E9	`da intake status`	Intake folder by folder: files, GB, photos, raw, documents, videos, hashed, already in organized	☐

F. Duplicates and undo (menu 4)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
F1	Open `_duplicates-holding` in the archive	Today's date folder with the 3 `doubles` (exact copies), and a `moved.csv` record	☐
F2	Press **4** (Undo last set-aside)	"Put 3 files back where they were (from ...)?"; answer **y**	☐
F3		"Restored 3"; the doubles are back in `intake\photos\kit\doubles`	☐
F4	Process intake again (menu 1, answer y)	The doubles are set aside again (they're still exact copies of filed photos)	☐
F5	Press **4** and answer **n**	Nothing changes	☐
F6	Delete the folder in `_duplicates-holding` yourself (they're copies)	Fine: DA doesn't need them	☐

G. Documents and scans

#	Do this	You should see	OK
G1	Open `documents\organized`	Year/month folders with `doc_YYMMDD_HHMMSS_xxxx.pdf` (and your Word/Excel file)	☐
G2	Compare a PDF's folder with the date it was created (File, Properties in a PDF reader)	It's filed by the date inside the PDF	☐
G3	The scans you put in `intake\scans`	Treated as **documents**, not photos; scans with no date wait under No date	☐
G4	A PDF with flaws (an old scanner's PDF, if you have one)	Processed without a stream of red/yellow warnings on the screen	☐
G5	Put a `.jpg` scan of a letter in `intake\docs` and process	It's filed under `documents`, not `photos`	☐

H. Contact sheets

#	Do this	You should see	OK
H1	Double-click a month's `_contact-sheet.pdf`	Page 1 is a **summary**: folder name, photo/video counts, the days, GPS count, places, sidecar versions, and a **Cameras** table with page numbers	☐
H2	Page 2 onwards	A section per camera: each page headed `<month> - <camera> / <owner>` (or just the camera)	☐
H3		12 pictures a page (3 across, 4 down), each with its name and date underneath	☐
H4	A photo taken outdoors with a phone	**GPS** in green down its left edge	☐
H5	Every picture	A small circled **2** at its top right (the sidecar version)	☐
H6	A video	A dark **VIDEO** tile with its length	☐
H7	A Live Photo	Shown once (its photo), not twice	☐
H8	Terminal: `da contact-sheets photos\organized --layout 4x5`	"Made or updated N"; that sheet now has 20 pictures a page	☐
H9	`da contact-sheets photos\organized` (no layout)	Sheets go back to 3x4	☐
H10	`da contact-sheets photos\organized --layout 9x9`	A clear message: a layout looks like 3x4 or 4x5	☐
H11	Run H9 again	"already up to date N" (nothing made again)	☐
H12	Copy one more photo into a month folder (with no sidecar) and run `da validate <that month folder>`	Its contact sheet is made again and includes the new photo	☐
H13	`da contact-sheets photos\organized --force`	Every sheet made again	☐
H14	In `da-archive.yaml` set `contact_sheets:` `layout: 4x5`, save, run H9	Sheets now 20 a page; set it back to `3x4` afterwards	☐

I. Videos, Live Photos and HEIC

#	Do this	You should see	OK
I1	Your ordinary videos	Filed in their month as `video_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS_xxxx.mov` (or `.mp4`) beside the photos	☐
I2	Open a video's `.meta.json`	A `video` block with `duration_seconds` and `recorded_at`; `classification` says `video`	☐
I3	A Live Photo (HEIC + MOV with the same name)	Both filed together: `photo_…_xxxx.heic` and `photo_…_xxxx.mov` (same name)	☐
I4	Copy a Live Photo's `.MOV` alone (without its photo) into intake, process	It stays in intake (it's the short video of a Live Photo)	☐
I5	Terminal: `da pair-movies`	It finds that video's filed photo and lists where it would go; nothing moves	☐
I6	`da pair-movies --apply`	"Moved 1" and an Undo line; the video is now beside its photo with the same name	☐
I7	`da intake undo "<the file it names>"`	The video goes back to intake	☐
I8	An old camera `.AVI` / `.MPG`	Filed by the date inside it, or listed under No date (then see J)	☐
I9	`da heic-to-jpg photos\organized\<year>\<month>`	JPG copies of the HEIC photos made in a folder beside it (the HEICs stay)	☐
I10	`da heic-to-jpg <a folder> --out C:\DA-test\jpgs`	The copies go to `C:\DA-test\jpgs`	☐

J. Fix dates (menu D)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
J1	Press **D**	Each intake folder with undated photos, one at a time, with a count and an example name	☐
J2	For the scans folder type `1998-07`, Enter	(B1's archive takes 2020-2029, so these will wait as "outside this archive's years" - that's expected)	☐
J3	For another folder type `July`, Enter	"'July' isn't a date DA reads. Use 1998, 1998-07, …" and it asks again	☐
J4	Type `2021-06-15`, Enter	Accepted	☐
J5	Press Enter on a folder	That folder is skipped	☐
J6		"Dates set on N files." and "Process intake now?"; answer **y**	☐
J7		The folder dated 2021-06-15 is filed as `photo_20210615_000000_xxxx` in `2021\2021-06`	☐
J8	Terminal: `da date list`	Photos still without a sure date, folder by folder (or "Every photo … has a sure date")	☐
J9	`da date set "<a scan>" --date 2022`	"Only a year: DA files them under 2022-01 (January)…", "Date set to 2022 on 1 file"	☐
J10	`da date set "<a scan>" --date "2022-03-04 14:30"`	Date set; after processing, named `photo_20220304_143000_…`	☐
J11	`da date set "<a scan>" --date 2022-13`	A clear message: not a real date	☐
J12	`da date clear "<that scan>"`	"Dates set by hand taken off on 1 file"	☐
J13	Pick a **filed** photo; `da date shift "<it>" --by +1h`	"Dates shifted +1h on 1 file" and a `da validate … --mode repair` line	☐
J14	Run that `da validate … --mode repair` line	The photo is renamed one hour later (and moved if the month changed)	☐
J15	`da date shift "<it>" --by -1h` and repair again	Back to its original name	☐
J16	`da date shift <folder> --by +2d` / `-30m` / `+1mo` / `-1y`	Each accepted (try one, then shift back)	☐
J17	`da date shift <folder> --by 1h` (no sign)	A clear message: use +1h, -30m, …	☐
J18	Shift a folder that includes an undated scan	The undated one is listed as skipped: "no sure date to shift"	☐

K. Tags (terminal)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
K1	In the archive: `da tag`	"Read camera details and make automatic tags for N photos in ...?"; answer **y**; "Tagged N photos"	☐
K2	Open a filed photo's `.meta.json`	`auto_tags` with tags like `maker:apple`, `camera:apple-iphone-…`, `year:2021`, and `gps` for outdoor photos	☐
K3	`da tag --cameras`	A table of the cameras found, with photo counts and years; it asks who used each (type a name like `jane`, or Enter to skip)	☐
K4		"saved: 	☐
K5	`da tag --owner "<a camera from K3>" sam`	"saved: ... -> sam" and "Update the owner: tags now?"	☐
K6	`da tag photos\organized\<year>\<month> beach`	"Your tags on N files: +beach"	☐
K7	`da tag photos\organized\<year>\<month> -x beach`	"-beach"	☐
K8	`da tag "<one photo>" grandma "summer trip"`	Tags `grandma` and `summer-trip` added to that photo	☐
K9	`da findit tags photos\organized -r grandma -v`	`"match_count": 1` and that photo	☐
K10	`da findit tags photos\organized -r gps -v`	The photos with a location	☐
K11	`da findit tags photos\organized -x gps -v`	The photos without	☐
K12	`da findit tags photos\organized -r owner:jane -v`	Photos from the camera you named in K3	☐
K13	`da tag --refresh` (answer y)	Camera details read again from every photo; tags unchanged	☐
K14	Open a contact sheet made after K3 (run `da contact-sheets <month>`)	The camera sections now show **/ jane**	☐

L. Places and location folders (menu L)

These need an internet connection, except L12.

#	Do this	You should see	OK
L1	Terminal: `da location lookup`	How many photos have a GPS position, how many new places, "about one a second", a privacy note; "Start?"	☐
L2	Answer **y**	A progress count, then "N of N GPS photos have a place" and a list like `place:springfield-il 24`	☐
L3	Run it again	"0 new spots"; it finishes at once (places are remembered)	☐
L4	`da findit tags photos\organized -r place:<one of the places> -v`	Those photos	☐
L5	`da db query "SELECT city, COUNT(*) FROM files GROUP BY city"`	Towns with counts	☐
L6	In the menu press **L**	"Months with GPS photos (newest first):" numbered	☐
L7	Type a month's number	Groups of photos taken close together: count, days and times, places, first file	☐
L8	For group 1 type a title like `Beach day` ; press Enter for the others	"DA will: make 2021-06 Beach day () (N photos)" and "Move them?"	☐
L9	Answer **y**	"Moved N photos into 1 folder; … contact sheets made" and an **Undo** line	☐
L10	Open the year folder	`2021-06 Beach day (<place>)` beside `2021-06` , with its own contact sheet; photos without GPS stayed in `2021-06`	☐
L11	`da validate "photos\organized\2021\2021-06 Beach day (<place>)"`	"Problems found: 0" (a location folder is a proper home)	☐
L12	`da location rename "<that folder>" "Beach with grandma"`	The new name, "Rename it?", then "Renamed; title set on N sidecars" and an Undo line	☐
L13	`da location set "<a photo without GPS>" --place "Springfield, IL"`	"Found: Springfield, …", asks, "Done: 1 photo"	☐
L14	`da location set "<another photo>" --same-as "<a GPS photo>"`	"Done: 1 photo" (no lookup)	☐
L15	`da location set "<that photo>" --clear`	"Done: 1 photo"	☐
L16	Group that month again with **L**	A group taken at the same time and place says "fits the folder already there"; Enter adds to it	☐
L17	`da location group photos\organized\<year>\<month> --hours 1 --km 0.5`	Smaller groups; answer **n** / press Enter to move nothing	☐

#	Do this	You should see	OK
L18	`da intake undo "<the file L9 named>"`	The photos go back to `2021-06`; the location folder is gone	☐
L19	`da location lookup --offline`	Uses only remembered places; nothing sent	☐
L20	In `da-archive.yaml` set `location:` `lookup: off`, run `da location lookup`	"Lookups are off in da-archive.yaml ..."; set it back afterwards	☐
L21	`da location group C:\DA-test` (not a month folder)	A clear message that it isn't a month folder	☐

M. Split by years (menu S)

Copy the kit's `old` photos (another decade) into jane-archive-202x's `intake\photos\old`, process intake (they stay: outside this archive's years). sam-archive-200x (from B12) takes 2000-2009.

#	Do this	You should see	OK
M1	In jane-archive-202x press **S**	"Working out the dates ...", "N files in intake were taken outside 2020-2029", and which archive each belongs in	☐
M2		"Move them to:" with sam-archive-200x listed; choose it	☐
M3		What will move (from → to) and "Move them?"; answer **y**	☐
M4		"Moved N files", an Undo line, and "Next: open sam-archive-200x ... 1 Process intake"	☐
M5	Open sam-archive-200x's `intake\photos\from-jane-archive-202x`	The old photos (and their sidecars)	☐
M6	In sam-archive-200x, process intake	They're filed in `2000s` year folders	☐
M7	Terminal (jane-archive-202x): `da split`	"0 files in intake were taken outside 2020-2029"	☐
M8	Undo instead (repeat M1-M4 with new old photos, then `da intake undo "<the file M4 named>"`)	They're back in jane's intake (works even across drives)	☐
M9	A decade with no archive yet	"N from the 1990s have no archive on this PC yet. Make one: da setup --years 1990-1999"	☐

N. Merge two copies (menu M)

Copy the whole `C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x` folder to `C:\DA-test\jane-copy`. Add 3 new photos to jane-copy's intake and process them **in jane-copy** (open its `Open DA.cmd`).

#	Do this	You should see	OK
N1	In **jane-archive-202x** press **M**	This PC's other archives listed; choose jane-copy (or type its folder)	☐
N2		"Indexing …", "Comparing …", "N files in jane-copy: M already here" and what would be copied (3 to the same folder and name here)	☐
N3		"Copy them?"; answer **y**	☐
N4		"Copied 3 files: 3 filed …" and an Undo line; the 3 photos are in jane-archive-202x's month folders	☐
N5	Look in jane-copy	Unchanged (merge only copies from it)	☐
N6	Press **M** again, choose jane-copy	"Nothing to copy"	☐
N7	`da intake undo "<the file N4 named>"`	The 3 copies are removed from jane-archive-202x	☐
N8	`da merge --from C:\DA-test\nowhere`	A clear message that it isn't an archive	☐

O. Report (menu R)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
O1	Press **R**	A short summary, then the PDF opens	☐
O2		One page: what's filed (photos, documents, videos, space, years), waiting for you, by year, cameras, places	☐
O3	Open the archive's `output` folder	`jane-archive-202x-report-YYYY-MM-DD.pdf`	☐
O4	`da report --refresh`	The index is refreshed first; the same day's PDF is replaced	☐
O5	`da report --open`	The PDF opens	☐

P. Update sidecars (menu J)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
P1	Press **J**	"N sidecars: N up to date (schema 2), 0 older." (everything DA made is current)	☐
P2	*(If you have an older DA archive)* run J there	How many are older and what would change, then "Upgrade N sidecars?"	☐
P3	Answer **y**	"Upgraded N sidecars", the backup folder, and a `--restore` line	☐
P4	Run the `--restore` line	"Put back N sidecars"	☐
P5	`da sidecar upgrade photos\organized\<year>`	Only that year is looked at	☐

Q. Checking what's filed (terminal)

#	Do this	You should see	OK
Q1	`da validate photos\organized`	A summary: files checked, problems found (0 or a few notes), nothing moved	☐
Q2	Rename a filed photo in Explorer to `test.jpg` (keep its `.meta.json` renamed to match: `test.jpg.meta.json`), then `da validate <its folder>`	A "wrong name" problem for it, nothing moved	☐
Q3	`da validate <its folder> --mode repair`	It's renamed back to `photo_…`	☐
Q4	`da validate intake --mode repair`	Refused: repair isn't for intake (use 1 Process intake / `da run`)	☐
Q5	`da validate C:\DA-test\kit-copy --archive C:\DA-test\jane-archive-202x` (any folder outside)	It checks that folder using jane's settings	☐
Q6	`da run intake\photos\kit\camera --yes`	That folder alone is processed, no questions	☐
Q7	`da check "<the preview report path from a run>"`	A check of that report	☐
Q8	`da verify "<a repair report path>"`	Every filed file's hash matches its sidecar	☐

R. Settings (da-archive.yaml)

Make a copy of `da-archive.yaml` first; put it back at the end.

#	Do this	You should see	OK
R1	Change `years:` to `"2021-2021"`, process a folder with 2022 photos	They wait as "outside this archive's years"	☐
R2	Add an intake folder: under `intake:` add `phone: photo`, then `da setup <this archive>`	`intake\phone` is created	☐
R3	Change `photoit:` `pattern:` to `{date_taken:%Y-%m-%d}_{hash:4}` and validate a month with `--mode repair`	Photos renamed like `2021-06-01_ab12.jpg` (change it back and repair again)	☐
R4	Break the file (delete a `:`), then `da status`	A clear message about da-archive.yaml (no crash)	☐
R5	Put the copy back, then `da status`	The Status as before	☐

S. Logs, records and safety

#	Do this	You should see	OK
S1	Open `logs\da.jsonl` in Notepad	One line per command: "da … started", "… finished in Ns", and lines for what was moved	☐
S2	Open `output\runs\`	A folder per run (`…-run`, `…-split`, `…-merge`, `…-location-group`, …) with its records	☐
S3	Start processing a big folder and press **Ctrl+C** during step 2	It stops; run it again and it carries on (nothing half-moved)	☐
S4	Run `da run --yes` in one window and `da status` in another	Status works while the run is going (don't run two changing commands at once - see the known problems)	☐
S5	Throughout: did DA ever delete a photo?	No (it only moves, and asks first)	☐

T. Another PC or a USB drive

#	Do this	You should see	OK
T1	Copy `C:\DA-test\sam-archive-200x` to a USB stick		☐
T2	On another PC with DA installed (or the same one, from the stick), double-click the stick's `Open DA.cmd`	The menu opens for that archive	☐
T3	`da archives`	The stick's archive is now on this PC's list	☐
T4	Unplug the stick, `da archives`	It's left out until it's plugged in again	☐

U. Messages when something's wrong

#	Do this	You should see	OK
U1	`da run` in `C:\` (not an archive)	"Not inside an archive ..." and how to open one	☐
U2	`da tag photos\organized\2099\2099-01` (a folder that doesn't exist)	*(Known problem: it's treated as a tag. See the known problems; undo with `da tag --remove photos-organized-2099-2099-01`.)*	☐
U3	`da location set <a photo> --place "zzzz nowhere"`	"Nothing found for ..."	☐
U4	Disconnect the internet, `da location lookup` on new GPS photos	It stops after two tries and says N photos still need a place; run again later	☐
U5	`da contact-sheets C:\nowhere`	"No such folder"	☐
U6	`da --help` and `da location --help` outside an archive	Help shows (no "not inside an archive")	☐

V. Clean up

#	Do this	You should see	OK
V1	Delete `C:\DA-test` and `C:\DA-test-kit` when you're done	(Your real photos were never touched)	☐
V2	To remove DA: delete `C:\Scripts\DA`, and remove it from your PATH (Settings, search "environment variables", Path)	`da` is no longer recognised	☐

Reporting a problem

1. Check the known problems first.
2. Open an issue at https://github.com/devmukmuk/DA/issues (a free GitHub account is needed), or send it to the person who asked you to test.
3. Include: the step number (**L9**), what you did, what you expected, what happened (a screenshot helps), your DA version (`da version`), and whether DA is the DA.exe or the Python install.
4. If DA printed an error, the archive's `logs\da.jsonl` has the details: copy the last few lines.
5. Leave out anything private: names, photos, and folder paths you'd rather not share.